



The Weight of Choices

Paragraph 3 精读展示 · 大学英语阅读

展示人: (填自己名字) · 日期: (填展示日期) · 用时: 6 分钟

Original Text — Paragraph 3

Perhaps the most **daunting** challenge for a freshman is the **sheer** number of choices that lie ahead. Choosing a major, deciding on minors, joining clubs, applying for internships, and even picking a career path — all these decisions **press down on** an 18-year-old who, just a year ago, was mainly concerned with passing high school exams. Many students fall into a **paralysis of analysis**, spending hours weighing pros and cons but never making a decision. Others rush into choices **impulsively**, only to regret them later. The question *'What do I want to do with my life?'* becomes a constant companion, whispering in moments of quiet and screaming in moments of panic.

 划出生词

daunting · sheer · impulsively · paralysis of analysis · press down on

 核心问句

What do I want to do with my life?

 两种反应

分析瘫痪 Paralysis of Analysis	冲动抉择 Impulsive Choices
-------------------------------	---------------------------

Key Vocabulary — The Weight of Choices (1/2)



词汇 1

daunting /'dɔːntɪŋ/

adj. 令人畏惧的；使人气馁的

The daunting task of choosing a major overwhelmed many freshmen.

搭配: daunting challenge / daunting prospect / daunting task

词汇 2

sheer /ʃɪr/

adj. 纯粹的；完全的（强调数量或程度）

The sheer number of options made it impossible to decide.

搭配: sheer volume / sheer force / sheer luck / sheer number

Key Vocabulary — The Weight of Choices (2/2)

词汇 3

impulsively /ɪmˈpʌlsɪvli/

adv. 冲动地；一时兴起地

She impulsively signed up for three clubs on the first day.

词根: impulse (n.) → impulsive (adj.) → impulsively (adv.)

词汇 4

paralysis of analysis

n. 分析瘫痪 — 因过度思考而无法做出决定

He suffered from paralysis of analysis, unable to pick a single major after weeks of research.

用法: fall into / suffer from paralysis of analysis



Key Vocabulary — Traps & Pressures

词汇 5

press down on

phr. v. 压迫；使感到沉重压力

The weight of expectations pressed down on her throughout the semester.

近义: weigh on / burden / overwhelm

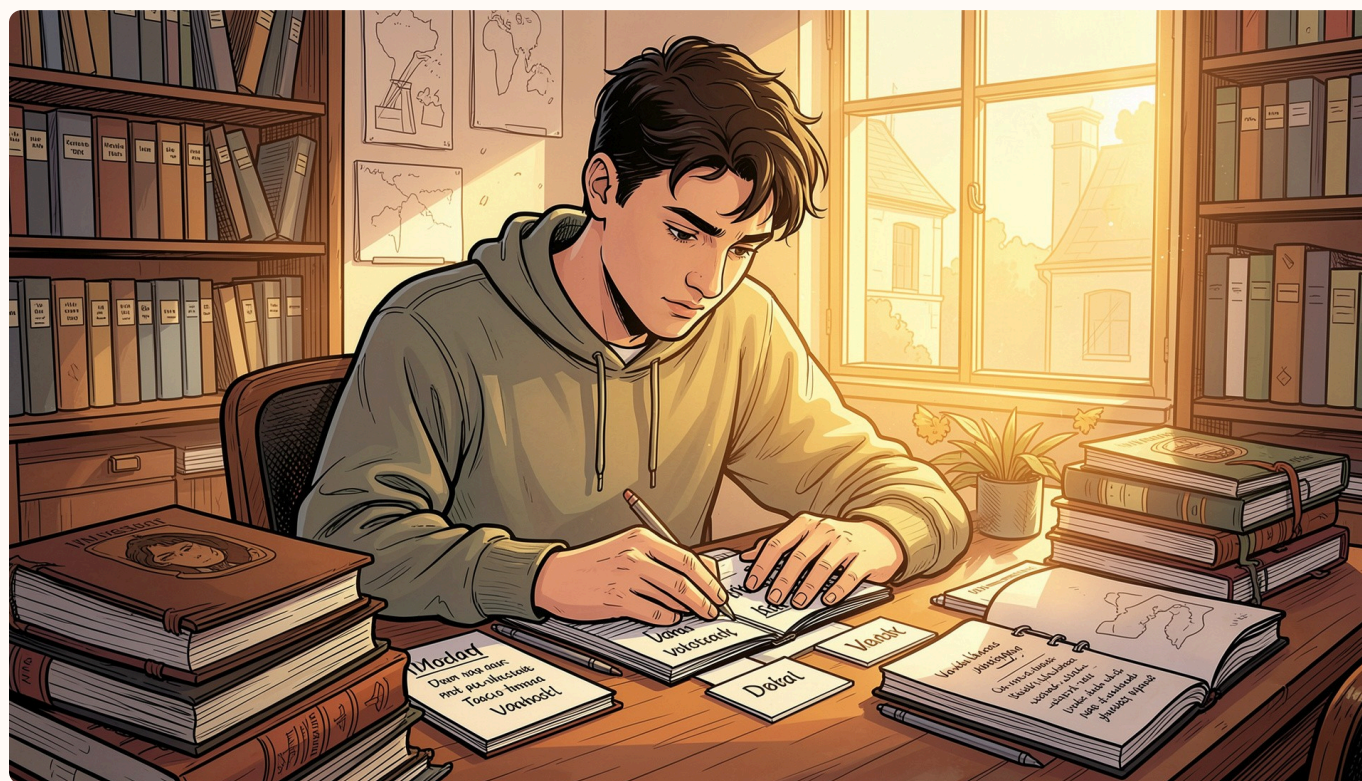
🔗 词汇拓展

→ **impulse** (n.) → **impulsive** (adj.) →
impulsively (adv.)

→ **daunt** (v.) → **daunting** (adj.) →
undaunted (adj. 不气馁的)

→ **analyze** (v.) → **analysis** (n.) → **paralysis**
of analysis (短语)

❏ **记忆技巧:** 词根 + 后缀法，串联整个词族，举一反三。



Sentence Analysis — The List of Choices

Choosing a major, deciding on minors, joining clubs, applying for internships, and even picking a career path — all these decisions press down on an 18-year-old who, just a year ago, was mainly concerned with passing high school exams.

结构拆解

1 五个动词并列

Choosing... deciding... joining... applying... picking —
层层叠加的选择清单

2 主句

all these decisions **press down on** an 18-year-old

3 定语从句

who... was mainly concerned with passing high school
exams

参考译文

选择专业、确定辅修、加入社团、申请实习，甚至规划职业道路——所有这些决定都压在一个18岁的年轻人身上，而就在一年前，他主要关心的还只是如何通过高中考试。

修辞手法

排比 (Accumulation): 五个动词短语层层叠加，制造强烈的压迫感与节奏感。读者在阅读中感受到与主角相同的重压。



Sentence Analysis — The Question That Never Leaves

The question 'What do I want to do with my life?' becomes a constant companion, whispering in moments of quiet and screaming in moments of panic.

🔍 结构拆解

- **主干（主系表）**：The question... becomes a constant companion
- **同位语**：'What do I want to do with my life?' 解释 the question
- **现在分词短语**：whispering... and screaming... 作伴随状语，拟人化修辞

👉 修辞亮点

拟人化 (Personification): **whisper** / **scream** 的对比赋予"问题"以生命，生动呈现焦虑的起伏——

whispering

平静时的低声细语

screaming

恐慌时的尖叫呐喊

段落主旨与作用分析

📌 **核心主旨:** 描绘大一新生面对众多人生选择时的"选择焦虑"——既有过度分析导致的决策瘫痪，也有仓促决策带来的后悔。

🎯 具体列举

专业、辅修、社团、实习、职业——展现选择的多样性和压力的来源，让读者直观感受到新生的处境。

⚖️ 对比手法

分析瘫痪 vs. 冲动抉择，两种极端并列呈现，深化读者对问题的理解，引发共鸣。

✍️ 拟人修辞

"constant companion"比喻焦虑的持久性和无处不在，whisper/scream 对比生动表达情绪起伏。

📖 铺垫作用

本段为后文可能的解决方案或应对建议铺垫，逻辑衔接自然，引导读者思考出路。

课堂讨论 — 你的选择焦虑

? 问题 1

你认为大一新生的“选择焦虑”主要来自哪些方面？

- A. 对自己的兴趣和能力认识不足
- B. 来自家长、社会的期望和压力
- C. 选择太多，害怕做错决定
- D. 以上都有

互动设计: 全班投票，邀请 2-3 位同学分享个人经历或看法。

? 问题 2

面对两个极端，你会如何做出更好的决策？

paralysis of analysis

过度分析 → 无法决定

impulsive choices

仓促决策 → 事后后悔

互动设计: 小组讨论（3-4 人一组，2 分钟），每组派代表分享 1 条建议，如：列出优先级、寻求建议、设定截止日期等。



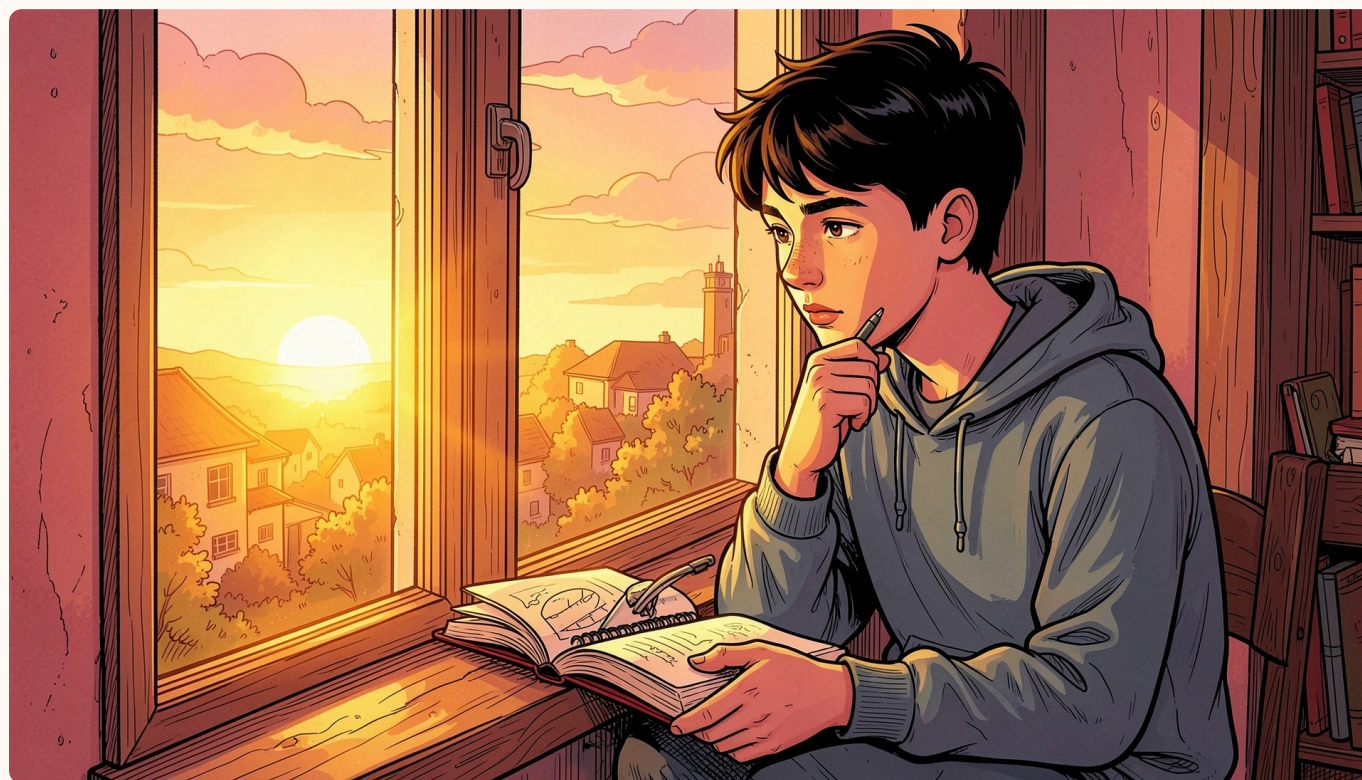
总结与延伸思考

💡 核心收获

- 选择焦虑是大一新生的**普遍现象**，既不要过度分析，也不要仓促决策
- 好的决策需要**思考与行动的平衡**
- 焦虑本身是**正常的**，关键是学会管理和应对

📖 学习建议

- 掌握关键词汇和短语搭配，理解段落逻辑
- 通过讨论，反思自己的决策方式
- 学会识别修辞手法（排比、拟人化），理解作者的表达意图



🌟 延伸思考

这段话对你的高中生活或未来大学生活有什么启示？你现在面临的选择中，有没有陷入**"分析瘫痪"**或**"冲动决策"**的情况？